Zisel Jewelry - Competitor Research

Draft site: https\://sip-coder.github.io/zisel-jewelry/ Rule: real sources only, link every claim, no invented prices or facts.

1. Website / Design (Designer Daisy, Oct 10, 2026)

11 jewelers reviewed from live homepage text and HTML. Tiffany and Cartier block automated fetches, so those notes are thinner. Photo and color calls still to come (screenshot board).

Las Vegas local

- Sky Diamonds: closest match to Zisel. Family with 40+ years wholesaling to other jewelers before opening to the public (about page). Hours and phone in header, "Transparent Value, No Brand Name Markup" trust list, reviews name staff, "Book an appointment" CTA, walk-ins welcome.
- D\&R House of Diamonds: private-office jeweler. Hero leads with "save hundreds, if not thousands," owners named, CAD custom work previews the ring on your hand. Real booking flow (Bookly plugin).
- The Fine Diamond: one-dealer site built around Matt by name. Testimonials list city and exact piece. Only CTA is "private inquiries by appointment."
- Judith Capital: sells on discretion, appointments at your location, NDAs on request, posted gold pricing. Heavy all-caps Oswald type.

Direct-to-consumer diamond and gold

- Brilliant Earth: huge mega-menu, promo-code banner, design-your-own flows, virtual and in-showroom appointments, trust strip (free shipping and returns, lifetime warranty, 24/7 support).
- Blue Nile: phone in header, Virtual Appointment, wall of short reviews. Outfit + Lora type.
- Mejuri: "Make it an event" lets customers host in-store get-togethers. Closest big-brand version of Zisel's showing parties.
- Catbird: gift nav by price tier (Under \$150 / \$300 / \$500 / \$1000), "Solid Gold, Always" trust line, bookable styling sessions.

Luxury references

- Tiffany & Co.: leads with Icon Collections and heritage ("since 1837").
- Cartier: real prices on homepage, "Make an appointment" section.

Copy

- Hours, phone, and showroom area at the top (Sky Diamonds).
- Real date-and-time booking picker (D\&R).
- Three-item trust strip.

- Testimonials with first name + piece bought (The Fine Diamond).
- Price-tier holiday gift navigation (Catbird).

Avoid

- Promo-code banners (undercut "wholesale").
- Giant mega-menus.
- All-caps heavy type.
- Long SEO neighborhood lists.

Do differently

- Lead with showing parties (only Mejuri does anything close).
- Explain why prices are wholesale, the way Sky tells its family story.
- Give the Hanukkah / Christmas / Valentine's pop-up its own dated section.

Draft-site gaps

- [PHONE], [DATES], [EMAIL], [@INSTAGRAM] still placeholders.
- No product photos yet.
- Guardrail (SipChief): testimonials, hours, and the wholesale-pricing story stay placeholder sections until the owner supplies real ones.

2. Businesses / Marketing (LinkedIn Lenny, Oct 10, 2026)

Full source notes: /workspace/jewelry/research/zisel_business_marketing.md

Highlights

- Vegas locals win on named staff and the "wholesale family" story. Sky Diamonds is rated 4.8 on 136 Yelp reviews; D\&R House of Diamonds is rated 4.9 on about 200.
- The Jewelers of Las Vegas has been family-owned since 1976 and has won Best of Las Vegas every year since 2008. Its holiday angle is gold chains as gifts.
- MJ Christensen is the only local running regular in-store events (Sparkle & Sip, workshops, Holiday Open House).
- Dumoni posts its full gold-chain prices and has about 48K Instagram followers.
- Showing-party models to borrow: Mejuri private events and its holiday Sip & Shop, Touchstone host tiers (15-25% of sales back as host credit), and The Finery House.
- Opening: no Vegas independent found sells hosted showing parties with host rewards.
- Gaps, not zeros: Instagram counts for Sky, D\&R, The Jewelers and MJ Christensen are unverified, and no 2025 holiday discounts were found for Vegas locals.

Zisel Jewelry — Competitor Businesses & Marketing (LinkedIn Lenny, Oct 10 2026)

All facts from linked sources, checked Oct 10 2026. Gaps noted, nothing estimated.

Vegas local

- Sky Diamonds (Town Square) — ex-wholesaler (40+ yrs to jewelers), public since 2019; "no brand name markup"; appointments + walk-ins, 11a–7p. Reputation: 4.8 on 136 Yelp (https\://maps.apple.com/place?place-id=IA3FBA82EF05B13F4), \~5.0 Google 341–422 per third-party trackers (https\://exa.ai/library/place/28jzh27n6py). Reviews repeatedly name staff (Amit, John Ray, Andreas) and say "no pressure" (https\://skydiamonds.com/).
- The Jewelers of Las Vegas — family-owned since 1976, 3 locations, "largest selection minutes from the Strip", RJ Best of Las Vegas every year since 2008 (https\://www.thejewelers.com/your-vision-our-craft-custom-jewelry-in-las-vegas/). Holiday social: "top 10 gold chains" gift post (search summary only, post not opened).
- D\&R House of Diamonds — appointment-only private office (Summerlin); 4.9 on \~200 reviews (https\://www.chamberofcommerce.com/business-directory/nevada/las-vegas/jewelry-store/2033800758-d-r-house-of-diamonds); "Best of Las Vegas" 10 yrs in a row per own Threads (https\://www.threads.com/@dandrhouseofdiamonds).
- MJ Christensen — 80+ yrs in Vegas; events page: "Sparkle & Sip" evenings, design workshops, customer appreciation day, gold-buying events, Holiday Open House (https\://mjchristensen.com/pages/events). \$5M Bridal Bash (https\://news.centurionjewelry.com/articles/detail/mj-christensen-diamonds-hosts-5-million-bridal-bash-july-17-26).
- Dumoni Jewelers (Downtown) — custom gold chains/grillz; posts full price menu (e.g. 4mm Cuban chain \$1,650, https\://dumoni.com/collections/chains); @dumonijewelers \~48.4K IG followers per third-party tracker (https\://viralist.ai/instagram/creators/dumonijewelers); also sells \$10k/\$40k jeweler courses (https\://dumoni.com/).

Showing-party / event models

- Mejuri — private store events: bridal sessions w/ sips + 15% off, piercing parties, give-back (up to 15% to charity), corporate Sip & Shop (https\://mejuri.com/company/mejuri-events). Holiday 2025: Dec 2–11 Sip & Shop, no fee 40+ guests, 15% off (https\://www.linkedin.com/posts/clanceysarah_looking-for-a-unique-way-to-celebrate-your-activity-7388609929756119040-83qa).
- Touchstone Crystal host tiers: 15–25% of sales as free credit + half-price picks; invite \~40 (https\://touchstonecrystal.com/regional/hosting).
- The Finery House "Traveling Jeweler" — fine/lab jewelry pop-ins at boutiques; 1:1 booked appointments; host gift 3ct lab diamond at \$20k sales (https\://thefineryhouse.com/pages/the-traveling-jeweler).

Gaps

Instagram counts for Sky, D\&R, The Jewelers, MJC not verified (IG blocks fetch). Specific 2025 holiday discounts for Vegas locals not found.

3. Jewelry / Product and Pricing (SipChief, Oct 10, 2026)

Full source report: /workspace/jewelry/research/zisel_product_competitor_research.md

Design implication (Daisy): each product card shows "laboratory-grown diamond" or "natural diamond" under the name, plus an IGI or GIA report badge.

Pricing display (SipChief): cards designed for a "from \$[PRICE]" line with optional "online retail \~\$X" comparison; fallback variant "wholesale price at your showing." Whether to show prices, and the prices themselves, are the owner's call.

Competitor table (15 jewelers, prices seen Oct 10, 2026)

Name	Location	Tier	Positioning	Price signal	Source
Sky Diamonds	6539 S Las Vegas Blvd Ste C112 (Town Square), Las Vegas NV	1 - Vegas local / ex-wholesale showroom	Mizrahi family; 40+ yrs importing & wholesaling to jewelers, opened to public 2019; 'Transparent value, no brand name markup'; private by-appointment consults; lifetime care	No public prices online (call/visit)	https\://skydiamonds.com/pages/about-us
The Jewelers of Las Vegas	2400 Western Ave (flagship, near Strip) + 2 Summerlin/West locations	1 - Vegas local / wholesale-to-public	Family-owned since 1976, 'Las Vegas' most trusted jeweler'; markets itself as wholesale jeweler; private consultations, same-day appts	No public prices; 90-day exchange for store credit only (no refunds)	https\://www.thejewelers.com/frequently-asked-questions/
D\&R House of Diamonds	1980 Festival Plaza Dr #530 (Downtown Summerlin), Las Vegas NV	1 - Vegas private office / by appointment	'Private office jeweler' - meet owners Dave & Rich by appointment; low overhead \= lower price; 'Best of Las Vegas' 9x	No public prices; free consultation booking online	https\://dandrhouseofdiamonds.com/engagement-rings/
DiamondsNColors	8965 S Eastern Ave Ste 160, Las Vegas NV	1 - Vegas private showroom / studio	Private no-pressure showroom; appointments strongly recommended; in-house custom	No public prices	https\://diamondsncolors.com/engagement-and-bridal/
The Diamond Store	750 S Rampart Blvd Ste 5, Las Vegas NV (+ Tucson)	1 - Vegas importer showroom	'One of America's leading diamond importers... eliminates the middleman'; walk-ins or private consultation	No public prices	https\://thediamondstoreusa.com/
MJ Christensen Diamonds	8980 W Charleston Blvd (Summerlin) + other LV locations	1 - Vegas established local retailer	Long-time local jeweler; 4.9 stars on \~2,500 Google reviews; designer brands + own MJ Signature line	No public prices in sources reviewed	https\://mjchristensen.com/pages/custom-jewelry-center
Jeffrey White Custom Jewelry	410 S Rampart Blvd #160 (Tivoli Village), Las Vegas NV	1 - Vegas custom studio	Bespoke/custom-first studio; publishes timelines and holiday-season lead-time guidance	Custom quoted; 4-12 wk custom timeline published	https\://www.jeffreywhite.com/post/custom-engagement-ring-timeline-in-las-vegas
Dumoni Jewelers	353 E Bonneville Ave Unit 173 (Downtown), Las Vegas NV	1 - Vegas custom gold / streetwear-luxe	In-house master jeweler, 'nothing outsourced'; transparent price menu; accepts Zelle/CashApp	\$1000 CAD deposit (credited); chains/pendants/earrings 1-3 wks	https\://dumoni.com/pages/custom-jewelry
Brilliant Earth	Online + \~45 US showrooms (no Las Vegas showroom listed; nearest incl. Scottsdale/LA area)	2 - Online DTC (lab + natural)	Ethical sourcing, lab + natural side by side, free shipping/returns, lifetime warranty, Affirm 0% up to 36 mo	6in 3ct tw lab tennis bracelet 14KW \$2,850 (IGI, F/G VS) seen 2026-10-10	https\://www.brilliantearth.com/6-in.-Certified-Lab-Diamond-Classic-Tennis-Bracelet-(3-ct.-tw.)-14K-White-Gold-BE5DTBS603LC/
Blue Nile	Online (US)	2 - Online DTC (natural	Largest online diamond retailer feel; frequent % off	7in 2ct tw natural tennis bracelet 14KW H-I/SI \$3,730; 1ct tw	https\://www.bluenile.com/jewelry/

Name	Location	Tier	Positioning	Price signal	Source
		+ lab)	sales; free overnight shipping; lifetime product warranty	natural six-prong studs \$3,820 list / \$2,674 sale; seen 2026-10-10	bracelets/7-four-prong-diamond-tennis-bracelet-in-14k-white-gold-2-ct-tw-h-i-si1-si2-item-252192
Mejuri	Online + boutiques (US/CA)	2 - Online DTC (gold fine jewelry)	Everyday 'self-purchase' fine jewelry; 14k solid recycled gold; 2-yr warranty; free returns	14k 1.3mm natural diamond tennis bracelet from \$2,600; 14k 2.5mm round box chain from \$1,900; seen 2026-10-10	https\://mejuri.com/products/diamond-tennis-bracelet
Kay Jewelers (Signet)	National chain; Meadows Mall 4300 Meadows Ln, Las Vegas + others	2 - Mass retail reference	Mall chain; constant markdowns (35% off); 30-day returns; lab-grown pushed into fashion	1ct tw lab studs 14KW F/SI2 \$909.99 (was \$1,399.99, OOS); 18in 2.4mm semi-solid 14k rope chain \$844.99 (was \$1,299.99); seen 2026-10-10	https\://www.kay.com/kay-labgrown-diamonds-solitaire-stud-earrings-1-ct-tw-14k-white-gold-fsi2/p/V-190281701
Tiffany & Co.	LV boutiques: Wynn, Bellagio, Shops at Crystals, Forum Shops	3 - Luxury reference	Heritage luxury, blue box, client advisors / appointments	Victoria tennis bracelet, platinum, 1.82 ct tw \$16,400 (non-returnable, exchange only); seen 2026-10-10	https\://www.tiffany.com/jewelry/bracelets/tiffany-victoria-platinum-diamond-bracelets-1526182323.html
Cartier	LV boutiques incl. Wynn, Crystals, Bellagio, Forum Shops	3 - Luxury reference	Iconic design codes, 18k gold only	LOVE classic yellow gold \$7,950 US per secondary tracker (Cartier page did not show price to fetcher)	https\://streetstylis.com/cartier-jewelry-prices/
Van Cleef & Arpels	LV boutiques at Wynn, Crystals	3 - Luxury reference	Lucky-motif icon brand; signature silhouette recognisable at a glance	5-motif Vintage Alhambra necklace \$12,500 per secondary tracker	https\://streetstylis.com/van-cleef-alhambra-prices/

Zisel Jewelry: Product & Competitor Research (Jewelry + Business Model)

Prepared Oct 10, 2026 (PT). Scope: product, pricing, materials, custom/showroom model, holiday promos, trust signals. Website design and social marketing are covered by teammates. All prices are real listed prices seen on **Oct 10, 2026** unless noted, with source links inline. Nothing below is estimated. Sections marked **[Analysis]** are my recommendations, not sourced facts.

Companion file: `competitors.csv` (15 competitors, 3 tiers).

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1. Competitor landscape (15 competitors, 3 tiers)

Tier 1: Las Vegas local, wholesale-to-public and private showroom jewelers (Zisel's direct competition)

Name	Location	Positioning	Signature products / styles
Sky Diamonds	Town Square, 6539 S Las Vegas Blvd	Mizrahi family, 40+ years importing and **wholesaling to other jewelers** before opening to the public in 2019. Pitch: "Transparent value, no brand name markup," private by-appointment consults, lifetime cleaning/sizing/appraisal (about)	"Largest loose diamond selection in Las Vegas," natural + lab side by side, 3D-rendered custom, Rolex
The Jewelers of Las Vegas	2400 Western Ave (near Strip) + Summerlin	Family-owned since 1976, "wholesale jeweler," private consultations, same-day appointments often available (FAQ)	Custom engagement, diamond necklaces, earrings, bracelets, gemstones. "GIA or equivalent" certs. **No refunds**: 90-day exchange for store credit only

Name	Location	Positioning	Signature products / styles
D\&R House of Diamonds	Downtown Summerlin, 1980 Festival Plaza Dr #530	**"Private office jeweler"**: by appointment only, sit with the two owners, no sales staff. Low overhead means lower prices. "Best of Las Vegas" 9x (source)	Loose mined + lab diamonds, designer/fashion jewelry, CAD custom with on-screen hand preview
Diamonds NColors	8965 S Eastern Ave #160	Private, no-pressure showroom; "strongly recommend" calling ahead for a private appointment	GIA natural, lab, colored gems, custom
The Diamond Store	750 S Rampart Blvd #5	"Leading diamond importer... eliminates the middleman"; walk-ins or private consultation	Diamonds, engagement, custom
MJ Christensen Diamonds	8980 W Charleston (Summerlin) + more	The established local name, 4.9★ from \~2,500 Google reviews (listing)	Designer brands (Hearts on Fire, Forevermark, Gabriel & Co.), own MJ Signature line, lab-grown, custom via CAD and **wax try-on**
Jeffrey White Custom Jewelry	Tivoli Village, 410 S Rampart #160	Bespoke studio; publishes clear timelines and holiday lead-time warnings	Custom engagement and fine jewelry
Dumoni Jewelers	Downtown, 353 E Bonneville Ave	In-house master jeweler, "nothing outsourced," **publishes a price menu**, takes Zelle/CashApp, Calendly booking	Custom gold chains, pendants, earrings, rings, grillz in 10k/14k/18k/24k

Also seen: the Meadows Mall cluster (Kay, Zales, "The Jewelry District" store at 4300 Meadows Ln) and T-Bird Jewels (1013 S Rampart, 4.9★/642) (listing). Gold buyers like Nevada Coin Mart note the **Cuban link is the most common chain seen in Las Vegas**.

Key pattern: almost no Vegas independent posts prices online. They all compete on "wholesale/importer roots + private appointment + lifetime care."

Tier 2: Online DTC and mass retail (where customers price-check)

Name	Positioning	Signature products
Brilliant Earth	Lab + natural side by side, IGI/GIA reports, free shipping/returns, free lifetime warranty, Affirm 0% up to 36 mo, \~45 showrooms (none listed in Las Vegas)	Lab tennis bracelets/necklaces, bezel styles, studs, design-your-own earrings/necklaces
Blue Nile	Big online catalog, natural/lab toggle on every item, frequent % off, free overnight shipping, lifetime product warranty	Studs, tennis bracelets, pendants, loose diamonds
Mejuri	Everyday "self-purchase" fine jewelry, 14k solid 90% recycled gold, 2-yr warranty	Gold chains, huggies, stacking pieces, fine tennis bracelets
Kay (Signet)	Mall chain with a store at Meadows Mall LV, permanent "35% off" pricing, 30-day returns	Lab studs, tennis, gold chains

Tier 3: Luxury references (all have boutiques on the Strip)

Tiffany has boutiques at Wynn, Bellagio, Crystals, and Forum Shops. The Shops at Wynn also host Graff, Cartier, Van Cleef & Arpels, and Bulgari.

Brand	Icon	Listed price
Tiffany & Co.	Victoria tennis bracelet, platinum, 1.82 ct tw	**\$16,400**, non-returnable (exchange only) (tiffany.com)
Cartier	LOVE bracelet, classic yellow gold	\$7,950 US (secondary price tracker; Cartier's page didn't show a price to my fetch) (streetstylis)
Van Cleef & Arpels	Vintage Alhambra 5-motif necklace	\$12,500 (secondary tracker) (streetstylis)

Lesson from luxury: each brand owns **one recognizable silhouette** (Love screw, Alhambra clover, Victoria marquise flower).

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2. What's selling: earrings, bracelets, necklaces (2025–2026)

- **Tennis bracelets are the #1 holiday gift.** "No girl has ever said, 'I don't want a tennis bracelet,'" designer Dana Gordon told National Jeweler. Tennis/rivière necklaces are right behind, and both are worn by men and women (Beyond Two Rings, citing National Jeweler).
- **Diamond essentials** (tennis bracelets, pendants, studs) are "the foundation." Studs now anchor a "curated ear," and tennis bracelets are stacked with chunky chains (Brilliant Earth 2026 trends).
- **Chains:** paperclip, herringbone, and rope link styles define necklaces (Brilliant Earth). Layering two chain lengths or a chain + pendant is a top gift move (Dainty London). Cuban link is the dominant chain in Las Vegas (Nevada Coin Mart).
- **Earrings:** huggies and sculptural or inside-out hoops are beating plain hoops (Dainty London; Whiteflash 2026 holiday). Studs remain the "first fine-jewelry gift."
- **Bezel settings, yellow gold, mixed shapes** (pear instead of round), **charms/initials/medallions** for personalization (Beyond Two Rings; Brilliant Earth).
- Fashion is moving toward **bolder gold** (cuffs, oversized hoops) and "everyday diamonds" (Marie Claire 2026).

Trend sources to keep watching: National Jeweler, JCK, Brilliant Earth trend guide, Marie Claire jewelry trends.

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3. Materials and anchor prices

Market context

- **Natural diamonds:** a 1 ct stone averages **\$3,898**, down 51% from \$8,007 in 2021 (Rapaport via CNBC, Sep 26 2026). De Beers paused its Venetia mine, and some see "the beginning of a recovery."
- **Lab-grown:** 61% of 2025 engagement rings had lab centers (The Knot, via CNBC). A comparable lab stone was \~\$450 vs \$2,800–3,200 natural on Brilliant Earth (CNBC). Lab gross margins run **60–65% vs 40–45% for naturals** (Gordon Brothers, via CNBC). Wholesale lab prices fell 26% in 2025 and 13% YoY in Q2 2026 but are stabilizing, with 1 ct rounds up 1%. US specialty lab jewelry sales rose 24% in Q2 (JCK, Jul 8 2026).
- **Gold:** spot settled **\$4,195.60/oz on Oct 9, 2026** (Gold Market Daily), \~22–25% below the January 2026 record. Gold-weight pieces (chains, hoops, cuffs) carry high material cost, so semi-solid/hollow and lower karats matter.
- **Karats:** 10k \= 41.7% gold (most durable/affordable), **14k \= 58.3% ("the sweet spot," most popular for custom)**, 18k \= 75% (richer color, premium) (Dumoni).

Anchor price table (listed prices, seen Oct 10, 2026)

Item	Retailer	Spec	Price	Source
1 ct tw studs, **natural**	Blue Nile	Six-prong, 14KW, H-I/SI	\$3,820 list / **\$2,674 sale**	link
1 ct tw studs, **natural**	Blue Nile	Halo, 14KW, H-I/SI	\$2,550 list / **\$1,785 sale**	link

Item	Retailer	Spec	Price	Source
1 ct tw studs, **lab**	Kay	14KW, F/SI2, certified	**\$909.99** (was \$1,399.99; out of stock)	link
Tennis bracelet, **natural**	Blue Nile	7", 2 ct tw, 14KW, H-I/SI	**\$3,730**	link
Tennis bracelet, **natural**	Mejuri	1.3 mm, \~0.82–1.03 ct, 14k YG, GHI/SI-I	**from \$2,600**	link
Tennis bracelet, **lab**	Brilliant Earth	6", 3 ct tw, 14KW, F/G VS, IGI	**\$2,850**	link
Tennis bracelet, **lab** (promo)	Van Adams Jewelers (GA independent), Black Friday 2025	14k, 2 ct / 3 ct	**\$1,295 / \$1,595**	link
14k gold chain	Kay	Rope, semi-solid, 18", 2.4 mm	**\$844.99** (was \$1,299.99)	link
14k gold chain	Mejuri	Round box, solid, 2.5 mm, 20"	**from \$1,900**	link
Luxury tennis	Tiffany	Victoria, platinum, 1.82 ct	**\$16,400**	link

[Analysis] "Wholesale pricing" only lands if Zisel visibly beats these numbers on comparable specs. The comparisons customers will make are: lab 1 ct tw studs (under \$910 Kay sale), lab 3 ct tennis (under \$2,850 Brilliant Earth, and local promos already at \$1,595), natural 2 ct tennis (under \$3,730 Blue Nile), and 14k chains priced by weight and solidity.

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4. Custom process, lead times, private showroom model

Typical custom flow: consult → sketch/CAD (days, plus 1–2 revision rounds) → stone sourcing → wax or 3D print try-on (MJ Christensen) → casting, setting, finishing → pickup (Jeffrey White; MJ Christensen).

Jeweler	Advertised lead time	Deposit / terms
Dumoni (LV)	Chains, pendants, earrings **1–3 wks**; engagement 3–6 wks	**\$1,000 CAD deposit**, credited; full payment at pickup; lifetime craftsmanship warranty (source)
Jeffrey White (LV)	Custom 4–12 wks; simple mods 2–3 wks; **add 2–4 wks Nov–Feb**; start 12–14 wks ahead for holiday proposals; jewelers stop taking holiday orders weeks early (source)	Quoted per project
D\&R (LV)	Not stated; CAD with on-hand screen preview	Free consultation booked online or by phone (source)

Private appointment and showroom models in Vegas:

- **By appointment only, private office:** D\&R. You meet the owners in a Summerlin office suite, and lower overhead is the selling point.
- **Showroom + "private consult" option:** Sky Diamonds, The Diamond Store, The Jewelers ("same-day appointments often available"), DiamondsNColors ("call ahead" recommended).
- **Booking channels:** online form (D\&R, The Jewelers), phone, Calendly (Dumoni). Brilliant Earth's booking flow is a good template: pick service (Engagement 50 min / **Fine Jewelry & Gifts 50 min** / drop-off 15 min), date/time, SMS reminders (BE product page booking modal).
- **Showing-party model (outside Vegas):** direct-sales hosts earn rewards. Park Lane gives the host a favorite item for \$35 and \$40 free credit at 10+ orders, ships directly to guests, and lets parties run virtually or in a restaurant/clubhouse (Park Lane host). Fine-jewelry trunk shows commonly give hosts 10–20% of sales in jewelry (per search summary of trunk-show programs, not individually verified).

[Analysis] No Vegas fine jeweler I found is marketing *showing parties*. That model is owned by costume/direct-sales brands, so it's open white space for Zisel.

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5. Holiday promo tactics (real examples)

2026 calendar: Hanukkah runs **sundown Fri Dec 4 – nightfall Sat Dec 12, 2026** (AJLuxe). Christmas is Dec 25. Valentine's is Sun Feb 14, 2027.

- **Gift-with-purchase diamonds** (the dominant tactic):
- Brilliant Earth Black Friday 2025 (Nov 15–29): free ½ ct lab studs over \$1,000, studs + lab necklace over \$3,000, code BLACKFRIDAY (StyleCaster). They're running it again right now: free ¼ ct lab studs over \$1,000, Oct 4–10, 2026 (BE).
- Van Adams: free 1 ct lab studs ("valued at \$895") with \$1,000+, plus "special buy" lab tennis bracelets at \$1,295 (2 ct) and \$1,595 (3 ct) (Van Adams).
- Arden Jewelers: free natural or lab studs over \$2,000 through Dec 24 (Arden).
- **Doorbuster hero items:** Van Adams marked a natural 10 ct riviera necklace from \$15,995 to \$9,995 and petite 14k diamond pendants from \$695 to \$495 (source).
- **Hanukkah:** "eight nights" framing. Small pieces most nights (studs, slim pendant), one bigger piece on one night. Star of David pendants in 14k for those who wear Jewish symbols (OD's Jewellers; AJLuxe).
- **Valentine's:** windowed sales plus a clear "order by" date. Samuelson's ran up to 30% off Feb 6–16 with order by Feb 11 (LinkedIn post). Major brands set Feb 11–12 deadlines (USA Today).
- **List-building sweepstakes:** Brilliant Earth gives away a \$1,000 gift card for email/SMS signup (Oct 2026) and a \$2,500 "Win Your Wish List" sweepstakes. Every product has a "Drop a Hint" button (BE).
- **Proposal-season urgency:** Nov–Feb is proposal season. Custom orders need 2–4 extra weeks, so "book by" deadlines are a legitimate hook (Jeffrey White).

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6. Trust signals buyers expect

- **Grading reports:** IGI still issues full 4Cs reports for lab-grown. **Since Oct 1, 2025, GIA no longer gives D–Z/clarity grades for lab-grown**, only a "Premium" or "Standard" quality assessment (National Jeweler; GIA). So: **IGI for lab, GIA for natural** is the norm (Brilliant Earth's lab tennis bracelet ships with an IGI report). Kay laser-inscribes certified lab centers.
- **Disclosure law (must-do):** under the FTC Jewelry Guides, lab-grown stones must be clearly and conspicuously described as "laboratory-grown," "laboratory-created," or "[manufacturer]-created" immediately next to the word "diamond." A disclosure buried in an FAQ or hashtag may not suffice (FTC). This applies to texts, flyers, and the website.
- **Warranties:** Blue Nile and Brilliant Earth offer lifetime product warranties, Mejuri 2 years, Dumoni a lifetime craftsmanship warranty. Sky Diamonds offers lifetime cleaning/sizing/appraisal.
- **Returns:** online sets the bar at **free 30-day returns** (Brilliant Earth, Kay). Local independents are stricter: The Jewelers has no refunds and 90-day store-credit exchanges, and custom pieces are non-returnable almost everywhere (Kay, The Jewelers, BE engraved items). Tiffany's Victoria bracelet is exchange-only.

- **Financing:** Brilliant Earth offers Affirm 0% APR up to 36 months, Wells Fargo 12-month financing, and layaway. Bank wire gets 1.5% off (BE).
- **Upgrade programs:** Brilliant Earth gives full-credit lifetime diamond upgrades, and Kay offers lifetime lab-grown trade-in.
- **Social proof:** MJ Christensen's \~2,500 reviews at 4.9★ and D\&R's "Best of Las Vegas 9x" are the local benchmarks.

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7. Opportunities and gaps for Zisel [Analysis, not sourced facts]

1. **Price transparency is the gap.** Every Vegas independent hides prices, while online shows them. Zisel can publish "from" prices or a short wholesale price menu (Dumoni proves a public menu works locally) for 5–8 hero items next to the Blue Nile/Brilliant Earth comparable. That makes "wholesale" provable instead of a slogan.
2. **Own showing parties.** Fine-jewelry home and suite showings are unclaimed in Vegas. Package it: host gets a gift (e.g., lab studs) plus credit tied to party sales, with a minimum guest count. Run it in homes, suites, or Ben's showroom, using Park Lane's structure at fine-jewelry price points.
3. **Lead with a tight hero assortment, not a catalog:** lab and natural tennis bracelets (2–3 ct), 1 ct tw studs, huggies, a tennis necklace, 14k chains (Cuban, rope, paperclip) plus a diamond pendant, and a holiday-only motif (Star of David, cross, initial, heart). This matches what's selling and what Vegas wears.
4. **Two-lane diamond story:** lab \= "more size per dollar" (plus higher margin, 60–65%). Natural \= "heritage," priced near historic lows (1 ct avg \$3,898). Show both side by side like Sky Diamonds and Brilliant Earth, with FTC-compliant labels.
5. **Holiday GWP beats % off for wholesale positioning.** Discounting undermines "already wholesale." A gift with purchase (free lab studs over a threshold) matches the market standard without signaling inflated base prices.
6. **Use custom as the urgency lever.** Publish "order custom by ___ for Hanukkah (Dec 4) / Christmas / Valentine's" deadlines based on a 1–3 week simple-piece timeline (Dumoni's benchmark), plus 2–4 weeks for holiday load.
7. **Signature silhouette.** Luxury wins on one recognizable motif. A "diamond over the i" detail could become a small diamond-dot motif on clasps and pendants, a cheap and ownable brand code.
8. **Match online trust basics** that local stores don't advertise: IGI/GIA report with every center stone, a written warranty, a clear exchange policy (custom final sale), and Affirm-style financing.
9. **Weekend/tourist access:** MJ Christensen closes Sundays and D\&R is appointment-only. Evening and weekend private showings for locals and visitors are a differentiator.
10. **Gold price risk:** with spot near \$4,200, quote chains by weight and solidity, offer 10k/semi-solid entry options, and hold quotes for a short window.

Caveats: Cartier and Van Cleef prices come from a secondary price tracker, because the brand pages didn't expose prices to my fetcher. Trunk-show host percentages come from a search summary. The Kay 1 ct lab stud was out of stock when seen. No competitor was contacted.

4. Takeaways

To be filled once all three sections land.

Next steps tracker

#	Item	Owner	Status
1	Website/design teardown	Designer Daisy	Done
2	Screenshot board (photography, color, mobile)	Designer Daisy	In progress
3	Competitor businesses/marketing	LinkedIn Lenny	Done
4	Jewelry/product/pricing research	SipChief	Done
5	Owner to supply phone, email, Instagram, pop-up dates	Zisel owner (via Jonathan)	Open
6	Owner to supply real testimonials, hours, wholesale story	Zisel owner (via Jonathan)	Open
7	Product photos	Zisel owner	Open
8	Final playbook (fills Takeaways)	SipChief	In progress
12	Host-reward ladder + dated holiday Sip & Shop	SipChief playbook, owner to approve	Open
13	Collect first real reviews early	Zisel owner (via Jonathan)	Open
9	Product card spec (lab/natural label + IGI/GIA badge, price + fallback variants)	Designer Daisy	In progress
10	Decision: show prices on cards or "wholesale price at your showing"	Zisel owner (via Jonathan)	Open
11	Holiday order-by dates for custom work (Hanukkah Dec 4-12, 2026)	Zisel owner (via Jonathan)	Open